1. Educating girls offers many benefits to current and future generations. Yet, in many developing countries, girls' illiteracy still remains a serious issue because **it** is often considered an obstacle to social and economic development. Over 120 million children of primary school age are not at school. The majority are girls, and Geetha is one of them.

2. Geetha can barely read and write. The pretty eleven-year-old girl is the youngest child in a poor family living in rural India. She was pulled out of school two years ago. Her father thought her time would be better spent looking after the family's goats and doing the housework.

3. Geetha's former teacher tried to convince Geetha's father and the village elders to send girls like Geetha back to school but in vain. "This is the way it has always been, and it will not change," her father argued. "I didn't study myself. We are simple people." Government incentives in the form of books, scholarships, uniforms, and even meals made no difference. A lifelong struggle to survive marked by poverty and ignorance has solidified their views.

4. The boys in the village attend school every day. They pass by Geetha who walks the narrow country road alongside her goats. "The boys tease me," she says, her big eyes full of sadness. She wished she could go with **them**. "When I was younger, I thought I'd study well and get a job. I really wanted to be a teacher. Now I just follow the goats."

5. Geetha has little hope for her own future. Like her mother and her grandmother, she will spend her life working in the fields and around the house. She has seen the value of education and has a different dream for her own children. "I will let my children study," she vows. Perhaps it is also not too late even for her. Many girls in India start school at a later age. With support from programs organized by the Indian government and international institutions, she may yet one day join the boys on their daily walk to school.

I- COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

BASE YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT.

A. WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING WOULD BE THE BEST TITLE FOR THE PASSAGE? (2 pts)

1. Poverty in Geetha's village
2. The story of Geetha's father
3. The problem of Geetha's education

THE BEST TITLE IS: ……

B. ARE THESE SENTENCES 'TRUE' OR 'FALSE'? JUSTIFY. (3 pts)

1. Geetha has never attended school.

……

……

2. Geetha's father thinks that sending her to school is not beneficial to the family.

……

……

3. Geetha's father was illiterate.

……

……

C. ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS. (3 pts)

1. Why is girls' illiteracy still a problem in developing countries?

……

……

2. What does the government offer to encourage girls to attend school?

……

……

3. How does Geetha feel when boys walk past her on their way to school?

……

……

D. COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING SENTENCES. (2 pts)

1. Geetha's previous teacher didn't succeed in ……

……

2. Geetha's dream is ……

……

E. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS THAT MEAN ALMOST THE SAME AS. (3 pts)

1. beautiful (paragraph 2): ……
2. make fun of (paragraph 4): ……
3. help (paragraph 5): ……

F. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO?(2 pts)

1. it: ……
2. Them: ……

KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

Testees should not be penalised for spelling or grammar mistakes in the comprehension section.

CHOOSE THE CORRECT OPTION: (2 pts) 3. The problem of Geetha's education

TRUE / FALSE: (3 pts)

1. **False.** "She was pulled out of school two years ago." (paragraph 2)
2. **True.** "Her father thought her time would be better spent looking after the family's goats and doing the housework." (paragraph 2)
3. **True.** "I didn't study myself." (paragraph 3)

WH QUESTIONS: (3 pts)

1. Because it is often considered an obstacle to social and economic development.
2. Incentives in the form of books, scholarships, uniforms, and even meals.
3. She feels sad (her eyes are full of sadness) because the boys tease her.

SENTENCE COMPLETION: (2 pts)

1. ...convincing Geetha's father and the village elders to send girls back to school.
2. ...to let her own children study (when she was younger she wanted to be a teacher).

RIGHT WORD MEANING: (3 pts) 1. pretty 2. tease 3. support

WORD REFERENCE: (2 pts) 1. Girls' illiteracy 2. The boys